SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA

THE LIVED EXPERIENCE OF RETIRED PNP PERSONNEL: A QUALITATIVE STUDY

ON POST SERVICE CHALLENGES AND

COPING MECHANISM

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CHAPTER 1

THE PROBLEM AND ITS SCOPE

1.1 Background of the study

Retired Personnel of the Philippine National Police (PNP) are individuals who were separated from service in the Philippine National Police, either through optional or compulsory retirement. After years in service, the Philippine National Police (PNP) has made modifications beyond what is required by law. A significant life event for members of the Philippine National Police is transitioning from active service to civilian life, marking the end of a protracted and challenging role in which they diligently strive to ensure public safety.

As mentioned by Edazawa et al. (2024), retirement from employment is a crucial step. The government has enacted laws that address this issue. Retirement entails leaving active duty as well as a host of post-service difficulties and challenges, including physical, psychological, social, and financial matters. Additionally, retired PNP officers often face similar challenges in developing coping strategies to maintain stability and dependability.

According to Gomez (2022), the main problems of retired police officers were financial and economic. Disturbing emotions, difficulty in adjusting, and quick bodily and mental decline are all part of it. Moreover, it represents social and emotional challenges.

An individual may internalize the role of a police officer, which can affect their identity when that role changes after retirement. As mentioned earlier, the police officers were assigned the responsibility of evaluating the implications of their transition roles from former police officers to civilians. Identity changes are often associated with changes in roles. Social ties and assistance from friends, family, and the police force appeared to be the most essential elements for retirement happiness and wellbeing (Tufano, 2018).

The retirement process for many organizations lacks the formality and care given to newcomers to the police force, with a focus on their struggles and resiliency in adjusting to civilian life after leaving the police culture. Retirees often make the transition with little to no assistance. Additionally, certain law enforcement officers experience identity loss, role residuals, and cumulative unresolved exposures to job stress, even if the majority of them transition effectively (Jones, 2022)

Recent studies have looked at retired police officers' lived experiences with retirement transitions, perceptions of their changing roles, psychological problems, and difficulties they had faced during this time, both positive and negative experiences that impacted their retirement (Kelsey, 2022).

A study by Smith (2016) aimed to explore the changes in the identities of former police officers after they left the force. It marks a significant shift from one's working life to the beginning of a new stage in life. Retirement is a special kind of organizational exit. A new job with the same identity after retirement indicates that participation in comparable employment options maintained a constant social identity from work life to retirement. These changes create new opportunities for the types of employment and leisure activities that older people can engage in, even if some may continue to work after retirement.

When the public perceives retired police officers as civilians, they may struggle to transition out of the force mentally. They will lose rewarding jobs and be isolated from a peer group that once provided them with safety, security, and companionship (Kinnaird, 2022).

According to Garcia (2024), this variation depends on the mindset of the individual going through the transition period, on how they handle changing their roles from being a police officer to a civilian, and how they handle the difficulties of their current status as a police

practitioner without the privileges and benefits associated with previous employment relationships. Regardless of how each person handles retirement, it is generally assumed that the transition will have some effects on them, either positively or negatively. In addition, retirees express concerns about losing their authority, lack of medical care, lack of financial support, emotional abuse when their presence is ignored, stress, and difficulty finding other employment opportunities. The solution produced a suggested action plan for improving supplemental support services programs for PNP retirees, as well as for their families, or to enhance policies.

It is not easy to acclimate to civilian life. Transitions are generally complex. The discomfort of change is something that no one enjoys. When officers depart, the police subculture must be replaced with relationships. When a primary duty becomes unfulfillable, they must devote time to seeking things that give their lives shape. They must rely on their loved ones for support (Kinnaird, 2022).

All of these experiences of retired Philippine National Police personnel were used to emphasize the advantage of post-service difficulties that could lead to identity modifications, mental health problems, social isolation, and financial challenges for retired troops. The purpose of this study is to determine how retired PNP officers adjust to civilian life following retirement. It also aims to draw attention to the identity shift from a uniformed police position to a civilian role and the impact this has on their happiness and overall wellbeing. A comprehensive and in-depth assessment of the potential outcomes, identifying their challenges and resilience, will help guide support initiatives and legislation aimed at enhancing the quality of life for retired law enforcement officers. Lastly, it also helps future researchers by contributing to the body of knowledge on occupation transition and identity, which is essential for a successful transition to civilian life; this study will enhance our understanding of retired lives.

1.2 Theoretical Framework

This research was based on the theories considered, including Biddle's Role Theory (1986), Atchley's Continuity Theory (1989), and Lazarus's Coping Theory (1993).

Role Theory

Role theory focuses on the characteristic behavior patterns or roles in one of the most significant aspects of social life. Roles are explained by assuming that people occupy social positions and have expectations for their own behavior and that of others. Moreover, social integration may be linked to its roles in a formal organization and the community, where actions convey a sense of self (Biddle, 1986).

According to Tufano (2018), role theory examines how behavior may be influenced by social membership when roles are altered. When a person's identity changes after retirement, for instance, it may be that they internalized the position of a police officer. When roles are altered, role theory examines how social membership may influence behavior. The role hypothesis posits that a work function can alter expectations in personality and behavior, which may be related to the status and authority associated with that position. If police officers over-identify or self-identify with their job, they may experience stress and poor health upon retirement.

The people's role in social connections is increasingly acknowledged as one of the key elements that influence their adjustment to retirement (Haslam et al., 2018).

According to the role theory of Henning et al. (2016), wellbeing and self-worth are essential aspects of the work.

Role theory suggests that for individuals whose job is central to their identity, retirement may be challenging (Damman et al., 2013).

Furthermore, it is essential to recognize the type of work performed before retirement, as this will influence the extent of loss retirees feel when leaving their careers. Specifically, those in law enforcement and other professions, compared to people who work in more solitary or non-team-based situations, often have a greater sense of identity-related loss after retirement (Charman, 2017).

Continuity Theory

According to continuity theory, as people age and experience life's changes, they strive to maintain the consistency of their external and internal structures, including their relationships, values, and activities. This theory explains how retired PNP members maintain their wellbeing through engaging in meaningful community service, maintaining daily routines, or staying in touch with former colleagues. With continuity transition, stress is reduced and a smoother transition to life following service is encouraged (Atchley, 1989).

Continuity theory emphasizes the importance of maintaining a certain level of continuity as retirees transition from employment to retirement, thereby preventing unfavorable outcomes during retirement. These hypotheses provided a framework for my investigation into seniors' perceptions of their experiences and adjustment to retirement, as well as the behavior of retirees in embracing a new lifestyle that is comparable to their preretirement lifestyle. Both theories served as a framework for analyzing the life experiences and circumstances surrounding the retirement of retired police officers (Kelsey, 2022).

According to Haslam et al. (2018), the three-phase retirement decision-making process and the framework for retirement transition adjustment concur. To provide a sense of personal

continuity in the face of change, role and continuity theories also place a strong emphasis on maintaining existing roles and relationships, particularly when retirement leads to the loss of some occupations and connections due to changes in job-related groupings.

Even if some retirees continue to exhibit consistent patterns of well-being over time, there may be subgroups of people who experience either higher or lower levels of well-being after retirement (Moreno-Agostino et al., 2021).

The continuity theory, as proposed by (Choi, 2025), suggests that certain retirees will maintain high levels of wellbeing throughout the process of adjusting to retirement. Programs that promote social interaction, volunteer work, or part-time jobs may help high-maintenance retirees maintain their involvement and wellbeing. Providing opportunities for people to stay connected and contribute to society should be the primary objective of community projects and legislation. Lastly, continued access to healthcare and wellness programs will be crucial to sustain the health of this population. Resources for physical and mental health, as well as assistance for healthy aging, are essential to ensuring that these retirees continue to lead satisfying lives.

Coping Theory

Highlights that coping is a crucial idea for theory and investigation regarding adaptability and wellbeing. The primary concern will be the differences between two approaches to coping: one that emphasizes style, treating coping as a personality trait, and another that emphasizes process, referring to stress-reduction strategies that evolve and are influenced by the adaptive context from which they originate (Lazarus, 1993).

According to Roach et al. (2016), social support could be crucial in coping mechanisms.

Practical strategies to promote a happy retirement, meet the psychological and social needs of an aging population, enhance wellbeing, and ease adjustment (Choi, 2025).

The behavioral and psychological methods people employ to manage, tolerate, mitigate, or minimize the effects of stressful situations are known as coping strategies (Jordan et al., 2016). Depending on the circumstances and coping strategies, the Way of Coping (WOC) can have a beneficial or harmful impact on psychological wellbeing (PWB). While maladaptive, emotion-focused techniques may reduce PWB, proactive, problem-focused strategies typically increase it (Lábadi et al., 2021).

The findings of Ryu & Fan (2022) indicate that retirees with a higher expected income had better coping scores, suggesting that financial stability provides more options and resources for managing stress, thereby enhancing coping skills.

1.3 Review of Related Literature

This chapter presents the related literature to provide a frame of reference for this study, focusing on the lived experiences of retired PNP personnel. The study examines Post-Service Challenges and Coping Mechanisms. The research identifies and analyzes the lived experiences of Retired PNP personnel, exploring the challenges they face and the coping mechanisms they employ in addressing difficulties and problems. It aims to provide insights, understanding, and improvement for future researchers.

Related Literatures

Retired PNP Personnel play a crucial role in understanding the life experiences of facing challenges, adapting, and coping mechanisms in civilian life, which are often caused by financial, psychological, and social challenges. A few retired police officers had trouble readjusting to their new lives from a uniformed Police attitude to a civilian one. The transition from structured law enforcement professions, characterized by a uniformed service mentality, to a civilian lifestyle and mindset presents considerable challenges for many retired police officers. To sustain

happiness and wellbeing after retirement, the adaptation process involves adjusting to changes in identity and establishing new social networks and coping mechanisms. When retirees transition out of the police culture and adapt to new social and personal realities outside the police organization, they often need to be resilient. Law enforcement officers, according to Jones (2022), transition well, while others suffer from identity loss, role residuals, and cumulative unresolved exposures to occupational stress.

The type of challenges faced by retired PNP Personnel after their service.

Financial and Economic Struggles

Numerous studies have demonstrated the interplay between financial and economic challenges during the retirement phase. Innocenti et al. (2023), found that those who were unable to save during the previous year were more likely to worry about their future financial security and were less likely to establish retirement preparations.

Law enforcement officers can find that their retirement benefits only partially offset their previous level of life (Bullock et al., 2018).

According to Layugan (2024), unclear benefit procedures and delayed pension processing cause financial hardships for many former police officers in the Philippines immediately after retirement.

Similarly, Edazawa et al. (2024) discovered that poor retirement planning and debt buildup before retirement worsen the financial situation of former PNP staff. These findings demonstrate how a combination of financial and economic stressors influences their wellbeing after leaving the service.

According to Gomez (2022), retired police officers were primarily affected by financial and economic issues. They typically play a significant role in meeting the needs, wants, and

desires of their family. Retired officers also suffered severe financial difficulties following their service, including unpaid debts and other commitments. Stated that financial problems after retirement, which were not brought on by a lack of asset growth or retirement planning before retirement, had little impact on their quality of life.

Washburn (2018) refuted the idea that retired law enforcement officers' pensions eliminate any financial worries or difficulties. Officers often lack the skills necessary to manage their financial planning after retirement, despite their pensions being fixed from the outset. After retirement, the typical pay is only a small portion of what they are used to, which causes some people to struggle to meet their basic needs.

In connection with the retirement experiences of police officers, the impact of financial circumstances on the retirement outcomes of police retirees was confirmed (Kelsey, 2022).

The challenges of retirement may impact the wellbeing and degree of life satisfaction of retirees. During times of transition, these can include losing social networks, experiencing financial difficulties, and losing prestige (Heybroek et al., 2015)

Advisors may purposefully select less-than-wise financial management choices that offer higher fees to profit themselves. Bad advice can lead retirees to make poor financial management decisions, resulting in significant financial difficulties. Financial scams target many retirees, especially older people (Fenge & Lee, 2018).

According to Carney et al. (2021), some individuals find the transition to retirement to be a stressful experience, marked by financial difficulties and a resultant lack of social connection, which can lead to feelings of abandonment and loneliness.

Researchers such as Rhee et al. (2016) found that involuntary retirement is negatively associated with mental health problems as a result of less perceived control of the retirees' finances.

Retirees are spending more time in retirement as life expectancy increases, which presents financial challenges if their savings are insufficient to sustain a more extended period without further income from employment (Savaş et al., 2023).

Loss of professional identity and status after leaving

Police retirement is a complex transition that involves not only leaving active duty but also losing social status, professional companionship, and organizational participation (Bullock et al., 2018).

According to Tufano (2018) found that police officers' role identity, a key component of their self-concept, is closely tied to their organizational culture and the duties associated with it. When people retire and their posts are eliminated, they feel as though they have lost their identity and struggle to reestablish themselves in civilian life.

Mandatory age regulation forces police officers to retire earlier than civilians, which complicates the transition from police duty to retirement. They often get disengaged from their professional identity early on as a result (Cameron & Griffiths, 2017).

The uniform representation, training, prestige, ranks, customs, and culture of the service may be missed by retired service members (de Medeiros & Rubinstein, 2016).

It can be challenging to define one's identity in retirement, especially for those who have a strong sense of identity tied to their career (Carney et al., 2021).

Forced retirement before a person is ready to make their own decisions can also have severe consequences. Emotional difficulties may be brought on by a sense of alienation or a loss of identity (Albertson, 2019).

Adverse effects included feeling alone and abandoned, not having enough time to prepare for retirement, losing money, having trouble finding a job in the civilian workforce, being depressed, and being angry over what they saw as unfair selection for involuntary retirement. When considering potential alternate courses of action, many expressed feeling furious and unhappy about their lack of power and impact. For all senior police officers, retirement is likely to be characterized by the shift from having authority and control to having none, which may need some preparation. Furthermore, several of the effects that have been documented, including a loss of role and prestige and a sense of loneliness, might have happened at any time after people left the police force. Furthermore, it is still necessary to investigate the special or extra contribution of involuntary retirement. However, it is possible that even though all officers lose their role and status when they retire, this group may experience it more acutely because they did not have enough time to prepare for the change that could impact their way of life (Cameron & Griffiths, 2017).

Rhee et al. (2016) state that medical or involuntary retirement deprives an individual of the option to make a motivated choice, as their inability to make a deliberate decision may hinder their adjustment to retirement. The perception of retirement by seniors as being forced or involuntary affects their identity, financial situation, and overall wellbeing—all of which are essential for living a satisfying life.

According to Jones (2022), law enforcement officers often navigate the transition with ease; however, others encounter difficulties related to role residuals, identity loss, and cumulative unresolved exposures to job stress.

Furthermore, losing one's identity as a police officer is a significant issue that many retiring police officers face, often accompanied by the perceived loss of relationships and camaraderie (Spraggins, 2019).

Social Reintegration into the Community

As a process and outcome, reintegration occurs when former members of regimented uniformed organizations, such as the military or police, resume meaningful roles in their communities, workplaces, and families while also reestablishing social networks, identities, and civic involvement. This process is affected by social, communicative, interpersonal, and community-organizational aspects (Elnitsky et al., 2017).

Ex-servicemen may struggle to rebuild relationships with family members and relate to civilians who are ignorant of or insensitive to the experiences that service members have of returning to civilian life, in addition to suffering from a terrible sense of loss, the most significant of which is the loss of their "self-identity" and distinctiveness (Sharma et al., 2021).

According to McCormack & Riley (2016), it can be challenging to integrate into civilian life following medical release without organizational help.

However, police culture views social support as a bad thing, which could have an impact on families in the future. Psychosocial functioning may be impacted by this significant turning point (Eagers et al., 2018).

According to Cramm et al. (2021), transition can also be a complicated process for family members, such as spouses and children.

Families may face challenges when service members leave their careers, and their spouses and children follow suit (Keeling et al., 2019).

When retirees lose institutional support and the close-knit group of fellow officers, the transition to civilian life may become more challenging. Retired officers may struggle to adjust to civilian norms, cope with stress, and establish new social roles in the absence of proactive social support or ongoing engagement (Hope, 2017).

The transition to retirement can lead to emotional distance in interpersonal relationships and often disrupt long-standing professional relationships, which can impact overall wellbeing and adaptation to civilian life (Carney et al., 2021).

Since many retirees rely on these contacts to make a smooth transition, social ties are another aspect of their functioning that may be affected (Haslam et al., 2018).

A sudden shift in status and the long-term development of new routines, depending on the retiring individuals' available resources, are characteristics of retirement (Wetzel et al., 2016).

The transition from service to civilian life will be challenging for many service members. However, recent research suggests that readjusting to civilian life presents additional challenges for female veterans and former service members. Additionally, a significant cultural transition occurs when a service member leaves the military and enters the civilian environment, which can impact several aspects of their identity, career path, and social integration (Smith et al., 2022).

According to Flack & Kite (2021) transitioning will be more challenging for veterans with a strong military identity, particularly in establishing community connections and social networks.

Unresolved medical conditions can hinder a veteran's ability to fully engage in a civilian job and schooling, making reintegration more challenging. Additionally, social activities are expected to increase the demand for public support (Bond et al., 2022).

According to the concept, transition processes involve changes to social networks, relationships, resources, and identity, which will affect both short-term and long-term problems (Markowitz et al., 2023).

The effects of these challenges on the overall wellbeing and adjustment of retired PNP personnel

Physical and Health Problems

The exposure to horrific events can cause physical and psychological strain that can affect a police officer's health even after they retire. These health problems could negatively impact their overall wellbeing and ability to adapt to life after duty (Violanti et al., 2018).

According to Van den Bogaard et al. (2016), preretirement circumstances, including psychological and physical employment pressures, have a significant impact on retirees' experiences.

Law enforcement officers are believed to be more susceptible to physical and mental health problems as a result of their exposure, which will have an impact on their retirement lifestyle (Steinkopf et al., 2015).

Among these possible issues are stress-related illnesses, alcoholism, depression, and trauma (Price, 2017).

Retiring often means making significant lifestyle changes that will affect the physical wellbeing of retired police officers. These critical life changes that accompany retirement can lead to people becoming more sedentary and consuming more alcohol. The demanding physical

demands of police work can lead to physical health issues like weight gain, high blood pressure, or diminished physical fitness. Still, these practices will cause problems for retired police officers (Agahi et al., 2018).

According to Setiawati & Margono (2025), retirement syndrome will result in mental health issues, social isolation, and physical decline if proper precautions are not taken.

Therefore, facing the stress of retirement, law enforcement personnel often experience existential crises and lack the expertise necessary to maintain their mental health (Washburn, 2018).

According to Perkins et al. (2019), post-transition challenges may include financial hardship, unstable housing, and mental health problems.

Additionally, poorly managed transitions put veterans at serious risk for things like homelessness, suicide, and declining both psychological and physical well-being (Bond et al., 2022).

Officers who experience terrible events throughout their careers, organizational burdens, or personal medical ailments will develop mental health issues like PTSD, which will last into retirement (Price, 2017).

Psychological/Emotional Difficulties

Psychological/Emotional Difficulties: As retired law enforcement personnel leave their tough, high-stress jobs, they have emotional, mental, and cognitive difficulties (Kelsey, 2022).

The loss of their sense of purpose and professional identity can sometimes cause psychological pain for retirees. Moreover, PNP retirees, especially those who have worked in the public sector for decades, may find it unpleasant and uncomfortable to lose their control and adjust to a slower pace of life (Hope, 2017).

Additionally, some retirees have typical psychological symptoms throughout retirement, such as worry and anxiety (Saraswat, 2017).

Due to the current situation, many police officers are aware of the physical, mental, and emotional challenges they face when they begin their retirement. While some people are strong and well-prepared to handle the challenges, others face loneliness, low self-esteem, and identity loss (Jones, 2022).

According to Price (2017), individuals may find it challenging to function at this level because of physical and psychological impairments they received while carrying out law enforcement duties that were not treated before retirement.

Those who reported experiencing depression after retirement were also less likely to move on; however, they started taking up voluntary or paid work elsewhere. Some had to move, which caused them to miss family time and resulted in a lower quality of life. Many people noted anxiety, depression, frustration, and difficulty sleeping. Some reported feeling emotionally tired, demotivated, and unable to continue living their lives, while one person characterized their extreme discouragement (Cameron & Griffiths, 2017).

A relatively small part of the needed aged retirees reported feeling more emotionally and psychologically distressed than the majority of retirees (Carney et al., 2021).

According to Kelsey (2022), former police officers who took part in the study stated that police officers who were forced to retire were more likely to suffer from depressive symptoms and abandonment.

After retiring, police officers often encounter psychological, physical, and emotional challenges, each of which has a distinct impact on the individual. Retirees usually experience an

emotional loss of identity, particularly the identity imposed by their organization, which includes their identification, badge, and firearm (Carney et al., 2021).

Social Isolation

Losing this police subculture could result in feelings of social support, connection, loneliness, and companionship, as well as an inability to rely on others for empathy readily. Long-term consequences, such as losing one's police authority, police family, and related identity, might persist even after retirement and hinder a person's ability to integrate into society (Kinnaird, 2022).

Many retirees experience social isolation due to a lack of social networks at work. This can be particularly apparent for departing officers, given the close-knit community that has developed within the force. Retirees typically experience a shift in their professional trajectories and social participation after leaving structured job environments, which frequently results in a decline in social networks and a sense of isolation. For retired police officers, whose profession is characterized by a strong sense of brotherhood, a hierarchical structure, and a shared identity within the law enforcement culture, this is particularly crucial. Because they no longer have regular contact with their peers or the sense of purpose that comes with policing, many police officers experience social isolation after retiring (Burkert & Hochfellner, 2017).

According to Hope (2017), many retirees, especially police officers, lose their social support system after quitting their jobs. Their social and psychological wellbeing might be negatively impacted by this loss, which can also result in emotional distress, a weakened sense of belonging, and feelings of loneliness.

Police veterans who may be dealing with mental health conditions like social isolation and alcohol and substance misuse can receive confidential support and referral services from Veteran Peer Support Officers VPSOs (Venville et al., 2024).

A lack of social connection can lead to feelings of loneliness and social isolation. One study examining identity loss investigated the elements of loneliness and social isolation that result from the transition. According to studies, those who leave the military often end relationships, making it more challenging for veterans to form new ones in the civilian world (Guthrie-Gower & Wilson-Menzfeld, 2022).

According to studies conducted in Wales and England, it is possible to mitigate and alleviate the negative and lonely sensations that often accompany the transition to retirement (Burton, 2025).

Moreover, the retiring officer is also leaving their colleague support groups, which could contribute to losses. The retiring officer may experience feelings of isolation and sadness for these reasons (Spraggins, 2019).

Ex-servicemen (ESM) experienced feelings of isolation. They were unable to converse or engage with civilians, even their friends and close relatives. They felt helpless, undervalued, and disappointed upon leaving the organization (Sharma et al., 2021).

Furthermore, the quality of life satisfaction will affect personality, decreased socialization, changes in lifestyles and activities, difficulty using time, and a search for a new identity, status after retirement, people's opinions about aging, and the level of respect they receive from others, even in the face of family relationships and societal challenges (Hussain & Jan, 2022).

The Coping Mechanisms Applied by Retired PNP Personnel.

Engaging in Hobbies or Family Activities

Taking up rewarding hobbies and repairing family ties are two popular strategies employed by former PNP members to cope with the challenges of post-service life. After leaving a demanding and structured police career to enter the civilian world, one may experience feelings of emptiness or a diminished sense of purpose. By participating in family activities, such as spending time with their children and grandchildren or attending community events, retirees can renew their sense of purpose and emotional connections. Emphasized that engaging in post-retirement activities, whether hobby or work-related, significantly improves life happiness. In a similar vein, former PNP officers who pursue hobbies and spend time with their families in retirement can maintain psychological balance, find happiness, and strengthen their family ties (Dingemans & Enkens, 2015).

Some individuals engage in healthy new pastimes, participate in charity work, attend social events, or engage in physical activities. (Agahi et al., 2018). Police officers have a unique skill set, work environment, and occupational identity. Work-related skills and experiences will be employed and transferred to other activities when adjusting to retirement (Henning et al., 2016b).

As people transition to a new stage of their lives, retirement—the time when employees leave full-time employment—is a significant life adjustment that presents both challenges and opportunities (Dingemans & Enkens, 2015).

For some, it provides a chance to relax, pursue hobbies, and spend time with loved ones (Musila et al., 2019).

In certain situations, participants were inspired to adopt healthy behaviors—such as joining sports clubs—by taking steps to regain the support they were missing. Significantly, there were individual variations in the retirees' fulfillment of the essential elements of retirement satisfaction (Fadeeva et al., 2025).

Joining Organizations or Associations

According to Bennett et al. (2016), people who have acquired skills from their previous occupations are more likely to work in bridge jobs and experience low psychological discomfort, high role overload, high pressure to retire, high professional goal achievement, and high traditional gender role orientation.

Other factors associated with participation in bridge employment after retirement include education level, race, marital status, health, job status/title, physical and mental capabilities, access to work, and pension (Oleksiyenko & Życzyńska-Ciołek, 2018).

Participants stated that these social and cultural shifts in retirees' lives are not uniform. According to the majority, entering politics was the most common experience among them. They received encouragement from their community members. They felt that since they were retired, they could afford to back their campaign. They were also thought to possess the character and aptitude for leadership, having previously served in law enforcement. However, only one of them made an unsuccessful attempt at entering politics (Gomez, 2022).

According to Clark et al. (2021), before permanently leaving the workforce, people often transition out of their career occupations and seek other employment opportunities.

Similarly, bridge employment refers to paid labor that older persons take on after their career job ends (early) but before they permanently quit. This could entail accepting a new

position, working for oneself, working for a different business, or transitioning into a new industry (Cahill & Quinn, 2020).

To make money and/or maintain a steady income while adjusting to retirement, some retirees choose to continue working after retirement, often as volunteers or part-timers (Agahi et al., 2018).

Maintaining Social Connections

Stigma and worries about appearing weak are the primary reasons why police personnel often feel more at ease asking friends and family for assistance than seeking help through official organizational initiatives. Similarly, maintaining relationships with family members and past coworkers offers retired PNP members emotional stability and a secure forum for sharing their stories. After retirement, these social ties help manage stress, alleviate loneliness, and maintain psychological health (Heffren & Hausdorf, 2016).

Tufano's (2018) study found that being socially engaged and receiving help from friends, family, and the police department were the most effective ways to achieve happiness and health in retirement.

According to Gomez (2022), participants stated that retirees considered other sources of income in addition to their monthly pension and retirement benefits. Several benefits that participants had experienced after retirement were mentioned. These included accumulated vacation time, a large payment, a sense of accomplishment, reduced stress, and spending more time with family. Spending time with family offers joy. Parents, particularly fathers, provide a sense of security for all family members. Every member of the family can have healthy interactions when they spend quality time together, whether at home or in a setting where

people go to relax and enjoy themselves. Family vacations and eating out are popular ways for families to spend time together.

According to meta-analytic studies, social involvement is significantly more critical than marital status, financial status, and work departure conditions. It is just as important as physical health when it comes to retirement transition (La Rue et al., 2022).

Through increased stability, stress management, and optimism, emotional resources—such as emotional regulation skills, optimistic outlooks, and receiving emotional support—consistently improve seniors' adaptability (Blekesaune & Hansen, 2021).

Playing golf or visiting the beach were examples of outdoor activities made possible by the improved climate (Ashton et al., 2019).

Additionally, the retirees' ability to afford language and dance classes, as well as their participation in their new lifestyle, led to them feeling more adventurous in their new way of life (Hayes, 2021).

According to Hsu et al. (2025), volunteering becomes increasingly significant as one ages. However, social interaction is essential during this stage of retirement. For retirees to continue retaining social connections and make a substantial contribution to society, policy measures should expand readily available opportunities for significant community involvement and planned volunteer programs that take into account various health circumstances.

1.4 Objectives of the Study

This study aimed to identify, assess, understand, and provide insights into the challenges and their overall impact on daily life experiences and coping mechanisms.

Specific Objectives

This study sought to pursue the following objectives:

- To identify the type of challenges faced by retired PNP Personnel Upon retirement from active service
- To assess the effects of these challenges on the overall wellbeing and adjustment of retired PNP personnel.
- To identify the coping mechanisms applied by retired PNP Personnel.

1.5 Definition of Terms

Coping Mechanisms. Refers to the methods and ways that retired Philippine police officers use to adapt to a new environment after their service.

- **Live experiences.** Refers to the life of a police officer after stepping down from the position.
- **Post-Service Challenges.** Referred to after serving as a police officer, they have faced difficulties adapting to civilian life.
- **Retired Police.** Refers to respondents in the research study that we are going to conduct to understand their lives after service.
- **Retirement.** It means the end of a long and challenging position.
- **Active Service.** Refers to the dedication of the police officers before their retirements.

CHAPTER 2

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

This chapter outlined the research methodology, including the research design, research materials and methods, research environment, population and sample, research data and analysis plan, and ethical standards.

2.1 Research Design

This study is a qualitative research project that looks at the difficulties retired Philippine National Police officers in Buenascar, Agusan del Norte, faced when they left heavy responsibilities in order to better understand their lived experiences. Through the experiences they had, the participants' problems can be identified, allowing for an assessment of the effects of difficulties and an evaluation of their coping strategies. It also reveals how retired police officers modify their coping strategies in the present. Data from various sources can be gathered and a deeper comprehension of this phenomenon can be attained through narrative data collection. The participants will participate in a series of in-person interviews to guarantee appropriate confidentiality and safeguard their identity and interests, thereby preventing external interference.

The qualitative research method is employed by the researchers to give a precise and understandable description of an event or people's experiences. This method is essential to creating a more thorough comprehension of different phenomena. Furthermore, this study uses a qualitative research approach, namely purposive sampling, which allows researchers to choose

participants according to predetermined standards (Kim et al., 2017). Understanding the lived experiences of retired PNP members, including coping strategies and post-service difficulties, is the goal of the study.

2.2 Research Materials and Methods

The research materials and techniques used to conduct the survey are presented in this section of the study. This makes it possible for researchers to collect data on the lived experiences of retired members of the Philippine National Police, specifically in determining the kinds of difficulties they encounter, evaluating the consequences of these difficulties, looking at the coping strategies they employ, and also adjusting to life after retirement.

Research Materials

The main research instrument used in this study will be provided with a guide question to maintain the study's purpose, specifically to address its research objectives. The guide included open-ended questions focusing on three main areas: The types of challenges experienced by retired PNP personnel; The effects of these challenges on their overall wellbeing and adjustment, and the coping mechanisms they apply to deal with these challenges.

An audio recording device will be used to capture the interviews for data gathering accurately. Taking notes is preferable for use in non-verbal interactions with respondents during the interview.

2.3 Research Environment, Population, and Sample

This study will be conducted at Buenascar, a municipality where retired Philippine National Police (PNP) personnel reside and actively participate in the community.

The study population is made up of retired Buenascar PNP officers who have adapted coping strategies to deal with a variety of post-service difficulties. The researchers deliberately chose participants who would offer rich, in-depth insights pertaining to the study's goals using purposive sampling.

Purposive sampling, a popular method in qualitative research that deliberately chooses participants with first-hand knowledge and experience of the research topic, was used in this study. This strategy made sure that the participants could offer insightful and in-depth information pertinent to the goals of the study.

The sample comprises a minimum of 10 retired PNP personnel, representing various ranks and years of service. These participants were chosen based on criteria such as retirement status, willingness to share personal experiences, and availability for in-depth interviews. This sample size enables a comprehensive qualitative analysis while ensuring relevance to the study's objectives.

2.4 Research Data and Analysis Plan

The methods for handling, processing, and evaluating participant data in order to meet the goals of the study are described in this section. Finding out what post-service challenges retired Philippine National Police (PNP) officers faced, how these challenges affected their general adjustment and well-being, and what coping mechanisms they used after retirement were the goals of the analysis.

Interview Guide

To gather qualitative information from the participants, a self-made semi-structured interview guide will be created. There are open-ended questions that are in line with the goals of the study. Participants are able to freely share their individual experiences and perspectives

regarding their post-service lives thanks to this structure. Kallio et al. (2016) semi-structured interviews support qualitative research by using prepared guiding questions while still allowing the interviewer to adapt and ask follow-up inquiries. This approach helps the researcher explore the topic in greater depth and keep the conversation natural.

The guide was divided into three parts:

Post-Service Challenges – Questions designed to explore the social, emotional, financial, and psychological challenges experienced after retirement. Effects on Wellbeing and Adjustment – Items focusing on how these challenges affected their daily living, mental health, and overall quality of life. Coping Mechanisms – Questions aimed at understanding the strategies and practices participants used to adapt and overcome these challenges.

Research Instrument

To ensure the response's dependability and accuracy in line with the study's objectives. Retired PNP officers will have the chance to share in-depth narratives of their lived experiences through an open-ended interview, with a focus on post-service difficulties and coping strategies that Philippine police officers encounter in retirement.

Data Gathering Procedure

To obtain authorization to formally contact possible study participants, a formal request letter will be sent to the Philippine National Police (PNP) office in Buenascar. Participants must be retired members of the Philippine National Police, regardless of age. The researchers created their own questionnaires and used an interview guide with open-ended questions to give participants flexibility and encouragement when sharing and presenting their personal narratives. To ensure that accurate information is obtained on time, each interview will last roughly thirty-five minutes.

Data Analysis

The interview responses from retired Philippine police officers were systematically evaluated using a qualitative descriptive approach and thematic analysis. Based on the questionnaires given during the interview, a detailed analysis of the participants' experiences and viewpoints will be conducted. In order to provide a comprehensive understanding of the post-service lived experiences of retired PNP personnel, the transcribed data was categorized into themes that revealed common difficulties and coping strategies. The research process involved:

Recording allows for the absorption of unfiltered information for the real-time responses of the participants to ensure accuracy. Transcription converting audio and video discussions into written form for data analysis. Translation ensuring uniformity by translating data from various languages or dialects. Coding identifying recurring patterns and categorizing data into relevant themes.

Categorization: Grouping responses based on the same shared challenges and operational difficulties. The thematic analysis will be used to analyze the themes expressed in the questions answered by the participants, enabling accurate results.

2.5 Research Ethical Standards

This study includes providing informed consent, protecting participants' privacy, maintaining anonymity and confidentiality, and reducing any possible risks. Sincerity, openness, and respect are maintained throughout the research process because the study complies with accepted ethical standards.

A. Intellectual Property Rights (IPR)

All involved intellectual property rights are respected and safeguarded in this study. The original idea and goal of the interview will be upheld by using the interview guide. No unique logos, brands, patented technologies, or trademarked materials were created or utilized.

B. Informed Consent

Retired PNP personnel will be fully informed about the study's purpose and procedures. Participants will be given formal informed consent voluntarily, with a clear understanding that they can withdraw at any time without consequence, depending on their comfort level.

C. Data Privacy and Confidentiality

All private and sensitive information shared by the participants will be handled with utmost care to ensure privacy. The data were anonymized to protect their identities and stored securely, with access limited to authorized researchers. Participants consented to the sharing of their data in an anonymized form only. The researcher ensures transparency with the participants to guarantee confidentiality and comfort during and after the interview.

D. Voluntary Participation and Freedom to Withdraw

The study ensured that all participants engaged voluntarily without coercion. The right of participants to withdraw or refuse to answer any question at any stage will be respected and valued. Ethical guidelines were strictly observed throughout the research.

E. Minimization of Harm and Risk Management

This study was conducted in a safe environment to minimize any psychological or emotional harm. Researchers provide support in language assistance and proper communication in the language preferred by the participants to ensure a clear understanding.

F. Beneficence and Contribution to Knowledge

The study benefits the academic community by providing insight into the post-service challenges and coping mechanisms of retired PNP personnel. Contributes ideas to future retirees on how to cope with the challenges that a retired police officer will be facing after completing the title, along with the responsibilities.

G. Justice and Fair Participant Selection

Participants were selected fairly using transparent inclusion and purposive sampling to maintain the quality of the study among retired PNP personnel. No discrimination will be involved in the selection, and ethical fairness will be ensured.

H. Data Integrity and Accuracy

Standardized data collection and analysis methods were used to ensure the reliability and validity of the findings. Instruments, such as interview guides, will be validated to ensure the accuracy of the information being collected.

I. Transparency and Honesty in Reporting

The research process, methods, data, and findings were reported clearly and honestly. AI tools will be used responsibly to assist in data analysis, and any limitations or errors will be openly discussed to maintain transparency and avoid publication bias.

J. Use of Patented or Copyrighted Materials

Proper permissions for any external copyrighted materials will be fully secured. No unauthorized use of patented or copyrighted content occurred, and all external resources will be duly acknowledged.

K. Ethical Considerations for Human Participants

Ethical standards regarding participants' rights, confidentiality, and informed consent were strictly adhered to. Participants had full awareness of the study's aims and the freedom to disengage voluntarily at any time. There will be no information that will harm any of the participants during and after the interview.

L. Responsible Use of AI and Related Technologies

Grammarly was used to enhance readability and grammar, ensuring the study's clarity and credibility while adhering to ethical use standards. The researchers will use AI and other related technologies responsibly, only for the proper enhancement of the information being collected.

M. Ethical Clearance and Institutional Approval

Ethical approval will be obtained from the Institutional Review Board of Saint Michael College of Caraga before the commencement of the study, ensuring compliance with all institutional and ethical protocols related to data collection and participant protection.

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